

NOVA IMS

Course title:	Portuguese
Language of instruction:	Portuguese / English
Contact hours:	54.00
Term:	Spring 2026

Course Description

This course emphasizes the development of basic communicative skills in Portuguese (speaking, listening, reading, and writing), together with the acquisition of fundamental grammatical structures. The course also introduces selected aspects of Portuguese culture and everyday life, addressing themes relevant to beginner-level language use.

Beyond its linguistic objectives, the course is designed to support the integration of recently arrived international students by facilitating their initial contact with the Portuguese language and communicative practices. Particular attention is given to promoting confidence, autonomy, and emotional comfort in real-life interactional contexts. The classroom is conceived as an inclusive and collaborative environment, encouraging peer interaction and intercultural exchange while students develop their proficiency in Portuguese.

Learning Objectives

By completing this course, students will:

- Identify and interpret sentences and frequently used expressions related to areas of most immediate relevance.
- Show basic communication skills in given situations requiring a simple and direct exchange of information on familiar and routine matters.
- Describe distinctive aspects of Portuguese grammar.
- Distinguish cultural features of the Portuguese language in different contexts.
- Express basic information about physical and emotional wellbeing (e.g., saying how they feel, talking about healthy habits, and simple strategies to cope with stress).
- By the end of the course, students who successfully complete all requirements will have attained a level of Portuguese equivalent to A1 of the CEFR (Common European Framework of Reference for Languages).

Course Prerequisites

No prerequisites.

Methods of Instruction

The course follows a communicative approach and covers all five language competences: spoken interaction, oral production and comprehension, writing, and reading. The approach to teaching and language acquisition is a functional one, in which students apply Portuguese to learn Portuguese. Committed to communicative language teaching, the methodological focus is on communication and meaning, while still paying attention to grammar, vocabulary and pronunciation. Students will be encouraged to produce oral and written texts paying special attention to effectiveness and adequacy to different communicative situations.

Assessment and Final Grade

1. Final Written Exam	30%
2. Midterm Written Test	20%
3. Final Oral Exam	20%
4. Oral presentation (in-class)	10%
5. Video Presentation 1	10%
6. Video Presentation 2	5%
7. Homework assignments	5%
TOTAL	100%

Course Requirements

- **Homework Assignments**

Students will complete weekly online homework assignments on Moodle based on the topics covered in class. These assignments are designed to consolidate grammar, vocabulary, and reading/writing skills developed throughout the course.

Each homework assignment is graded. Failure to submit an assignment results in a grade of zero for that task. All grades, including zeros, are included in the calculation of the homework component.

The final Homework Assignments grade corresponds to the average of all homework assignments, which contributes 5% to the final course grade.

- **Written Test (Midterm)**

The exam is rated on a scale of 0-100 points, with students being given 1 hour to complete it. The test will evaluate students' reading and listening comprehension, writing, grammar, and vocabulary.

- **Video Presentation 1**

Students will record and upload a video (2–3 minutes) presenting a healthy recipe. They should describe the ingredients, preparation steps, and personal connection to the dish. The video should be recorded in Portuguese and uploaded to the Moodle platform by the deadline specified in class.

This presentation focuses on vocabulary acquisition, pronunciation, and fluency. It is worth 10% of the final grade.

- **Video Presentation 2**

This second video task consists of a 2–3 minute recording in which students present a popular festival or celebration from their country or region. They should explain when it takes place, its cultural meaning, and what people typically do during the event. Students are encouraged to include visual materials or photos. The video must be submitted on Moodle by the assigned deadline.

This assignment evaluates the student's ability to convey information using descriptive language and cultural references. It represents 5% of the final grade.

Important notes

- All tasks must be in Portuguese, even if simple.
- Late submissions are not accepted, unless due to serious justification.
- You may use dictionaries or class materials, but AI-generated or copied work is not accepted.
- Feedback may be given collectively or individually at the instructor's discretion.

- **Final Oral Exam**

Students will complete a final oral exam in pairs, with a duration of 5 to 10 minutes per pair. The pairs will be assigned by the instructor in advance to ensure a balanced evaluation.

During the exam, each pair will receive a set of visual or textual prompts (e.g., pictures, short descriptions, questions, or dialogue starters) provided by the teacher. Based on these prompts, the students will engage in a short, spontaneous dialogue, involving asking and answering questions, describing situations, giving opinions, or solving simple communicative tasks in Portuguese.

The objective of the exam is to evaluate students' ability to interact in everyday situations using the language learned throughout the course.

Evaluation will be based on the official oral performance rubric, previously shared and discussed in class, ensuring consistency and transparency in assessment.

- **Final Written Exam**

Format and Structure

The final written exam will last **1 hour and 30 minutes**, with an additional **30 minutes of tolerance**.

It will be divided into **three main parts**:

1. Reading Comprehension (Part I)

- You will read a short text and answer questions to demonstrate your understanding.
- Questions may include **multiple choice**, **true/false**, and **matching exercises**.

2. Grammar (Part II)

- This section will test your knowledge of the grammar topics covered in class.
- The exercises may include **gap-filling**, **sentence completion**, and **multiple-choice questions**.

3. Written Production (Part III)

- You will write a short text based on a topic discussed in class.
- This is a **free-response** section with **specific word limits** (minimum and maximum word count will be indicated).
- Evaluation will consider **content**, **coherence**, **grammar accuracy**, and **vocabulary**.

Please remember: all exam content is based on material covered throughout the course. Reviewing class materials and participating actively will help you prepare effectively.

● **In-Class Oral Presentation**

In the final phase of the course, students will deliver an **individual in-class oral presentation** expanding on the topic explored in **Video Presentation 2**.

The presentation must be delivered **without reading from written notes or scripts**. The objective is to assess the student's ability to communicate ideas spontaneously and clearly in Portuguese.

Students are encouraged to use **multimedia support** (images, slides, photos, short videos, objects, etc.), which should serve only as visual aids and not as written prompts.

Attendance

Students must attend at least 88.9% of sessions. This means that students may miss **no more than three classes**.

Students who do not meet this requirement **will not be eligible for final grading**.

Assignment Due Dates and Penalties

All assignment deadlines will be communicated in class and posted on Moodle. Students are expected to respect these deadlines in order to stay on track and ensure timely feedback.

Late submissions are not permitted, except in exceptional circumstances discussed directly with the instructor.

In such cases, a new reasonable deadline may be agreed upon, provided that it does not extend beyond the date of the Final Oral Exam.

Any request for an extension must be addressed directly to the instructor, who will evaluate the situation and decide whether an extension can be granted.

Please note that technical problems (e.g., computer failure or poor internet connection) are not generally considered valid grounds for extensions, so students are encouraged to complete and submit their work ahead of time.

Although some flexibility exists, regular lateness without justification may affect the student's overall performance and participation in the course. Extensions are not automatic and will only be considered if the student communicates the issue in advance or as soon as reasonably possible.

Academic Integrity

Academic integrity is essential to a positive and inclusive teaching and learning environment. All students are expected to complete coursework responsibilities with fairness, respect, and honesty. Failure to do so by seeking unfair advantage over others or misrepresenting someone else's work as your own can result in grade penalties.

N.B. Course schedule is subject to change. The final duration and distribution of content and assignments will be determined and presented to students at the onset of the course.

Weekly Schedule

Class 1 - February 24

Language and Communication 1

Course Introduction and Icebreaker Activities. In this initial session, students will be introduced to the course structure, objectives, and expectations. The class will begin

with an icebreaker activity designed to encourage interaction and help students get to know one another.

Students will also learn how to greet others and introduce themselves in Portuguese, using formal and informal expressions appropriately.

Grammar 1:

Grammar topics will include the **Portuguese alphabet** and a set of **useful words and expressions** that are essential for basic classroom and conversational interactions.

Exercises:

- Pronunciation and spelling practice using the alphabet
- Oral practice: greetings and self-introductions
- Listening comprehension
- Repetition and role-play

Class 2 - February 26

Language and Communication 2

Giving and Asking for Personal Information. Students will learn how to ask for and provide personal information, including name, age, nationality, and contact details. This section will focus on developing basic conversational skills used in introductory exchanges, both in formal and informal contexts.

Grammar 2:

The grammar component covers the **personal pronouns**, the **present tense of regular verbs**, and the **irregular verbs ser, ter, and the reflexive verb chamar-se**. Students will also learn **numbers from 0 to 50**, which are essential for communicating age, phone numbers, and addresses.

Exercises:

- Listening and completing dialogues
- Filling in personal data forms
- Oral pair work: asking and answering personal questions
- Conjugation drills for regular and irregular verbs
- Number recognition and pronunciation practice

Class 3 - March 3

Language and Communication 3

Name and Personal Information: Name, Nationality, and Place of Origin. Students will expand their ability to give and ask for personal information, focusing on how to say their name, nationality, and where they are from. Emphasis will be placed on pronunciation and accurate use of basic vocabulary in everyday interactions.

Grammar 3:

The grammar focus will be on the present tense of regular verbs from the first conjugation (-ar verbs) and the correct use of interrogatives such as *onde* (where), *como* (how), and *qual* (which) to ask questions in context.

Exercises:

- Question and answer oral practice
- Filling out identification cards
- Listening to personal introductions
- Matching personal information with speakers
- Sentence transformation using interrogatives

Class 4 - March 5

Language and Communication 4

Personal Information: Profession, Age, Marital Status, Residence, Address, and Languages. Students will learn how to talk about their **job, age, marital status, place of residence, address, and languages spoken**. This section aims to build fluency in providing and requesting more detailed personal information in everyday conversations.

Grammar 4:

The grammar focus includes the **preposition em** and its **contractions with definite articles**, the use of **indefinite articles**, the **negative form** in simple sentences, and **numbers from 50 to 100**.

Exercises:

- Listening comprehension
- Completing identity forms
- Oral pair work
- Grammar drills on contractions and negation
- Number-based information gap activities

Class 5 - March 10

Language and Communication 5

Family and Simple Descriptions of People. Students will learn to describe their **family members** and **talk about people** using simple physical and character traits. This section focuses on expressing **relationships** and giving **basic personal descriptions**, reinforcing communication in familiar, everyday contexts.

Grammar 5:

Grammar topics include the **present tense of regular -er verbs**, the distinction and use of **ser and estar**, and **possessive adjectives**.

Exercises:

- Describing photos of family members
- Matching descriptions with images
- Completing sentences with *ser*, *estar* and possessives
- Listening and identifying family relationships
- Short guided writing: "My family"

Class 6 - March 12

Language and Communication 6

In this section, students will learn to describe people and objects in terms of physical appearance and personality traits, as well as to talk about personal interests and hobbies. The classroom context will be used as a starting point for practicing vocabulary and interaction.

Grammar 6:

The grammar focus includes:

- Prepositions and prepositional phrases of place
- Demonstrative pronouns and adjectives

- The interrogative word “Onde?” (Where?)
- Adjective-noun agreement (gender and number concord)

Exercises:

- Describing classmates and classroom items
- Matching physical and personality adjectives
- Asking and answering about object location
- Group discussion on hobbies and preferences
- Grammar practice on adjective agreement

Class 7 - March 17

Language and Communication 7

Students will explore vocabulary related to the **days of the week, months, and birthday dates**, as well as **eating habits** in Portugal. The section introduces typical meals, common foods, and cultural aspects of Portuguese cuisine. This will help students describe their own eating routines and compare them with Portuguese customs.

Grammar 7:

In grammar, students will study **time prepositions**, learning how to express when events happen using correct structures for days, months, and specific dates.

Exercises:

- Listening and matching days and months
- Completing dialogues about birthdays and eating routines
- Talking about your birthday and what you usually eat
- Identifying correct use of time prepositions
- Class survey about food preferences and routines

Class 8 - March 19

Language and Communication 8

Students will deepen their knowledge of **eating habits and food culture** in Portugal. They will learn to describe daily meals, express preferences, and talk about traditional Portuguese foods. This topic encourages comparisons with their own food routines and promotes cultural awareness.

Grammar 8:

In grammar, the focus will be on **prepositions of time**, especially as they relate to meals, schedules, and habitual actions.

Exercises:

- Describing daily eating habits
- Classifying foods into meals (breakfast, lunch, dinner)
- Matching activities with the correct time prepositions
- Pair interviews about favorite meals and food routines
- Short writing task about a typical eating day

Class 9 - March 24

Language and Communication 9

Students will learn to describe the **house and its components**, including types of housing, rooms, and furniture. This section emphasizes vocabulary related to the layout of a house and provides the tools to talk about where objects and people are located within the home.

Grammar 9:

In grammar, the focus will be on the use of **prepositional phrases of place**, and the verbs **ser**, **estar**, and **ficar** to express location, permanence, and temporary states.

Exercises:

- Labeling rooms and furniture on a floor plan
- Describing one's own house or apartment
- Using *ser/estar/ficar* to describe where things are
- Matching descriptions to pictures of homes
- Group task: designing and describing a dream home

Class 10 - March 27

Language and Communication 10

Students will explore **transportation vocabulary** in Portuguese, focusing on common modes of transport and how to ask for and give directions or information about location and movement in urban settings. The section emphasizes everyday communicative situations, such as asking where a place is or how to get somewhere using public or private transport.

Grammar 10:

The grammar topic covered is the use of **prepositions of movement** (e.g., para, até, por), which are essential to construct accurate and meaningful directions and location-related expressions.

Exercises:

- Map-based tasks for giving and asking directions
- Dialogue completion about transport routines
- Matching transport modes to scenarios
- Listening exercise: identifying transport and destinations
- Role-play: asking for directions in the city

Easter Break - March 30 to April 5

Class 11 - April 7

Language and Communication 11

Students will learn to **interact in commercial spaces**, such as shops and markets, by practicing vocabulary and expressions related to prices, quantities, and comparisons between products. The focus is on real-life dialogues involving buying and selling, preferences, and evaluations of products and services.

Grammar 11:

The grammar topics include the **comparative degree of adjectives**, **numerals from 100 to 1000**, and **periphrastic verb constructions**. The section also introduces **irregular verbs** commonly used in shopping contexts.

Exercises:

- Listening comprehension in store settings
- Fill-in-the-blank dialogues with numerals and adjectives
- Comparative descriptions of products
- Matching expressions to shopping contexts
- Role-play: buying and comparing items

Class 12 - April 9

Language and Communication 12

Students will learn to describe the **weather and seasons** in Portuguese, including expressions related to temperature, atmospheric conditions, and seasonal characteristics. The goal is to use appropriate vocabulary and grammar to talk about the weather in everyday conversations and describe different times of the year.

Grammar 12:

Grammar focus includes the **present tense of irregular verbs** such as *dar*, *fazer*, *trazer*, and *pôr*. Students will also learn the **periphrastic structure *ir + infinitive*** to express future intentions related to weather plans or seasonal activities.

Exercises:

- Reading and describing weather forecasts
- Matching seasons with activities
- Completing sentences with the correct verb form
- Weather role-play dialogues
- Planning seasonal activities using *ir + infinitive*

Master Thesis Defense: April 13 to April 18

Class 13 - April 21

Language and Communication 14

Students will explore the topic of **clothing**, focusing on how to describe what people wear in different contexts and seasons. This includes vocabulary related to clothing

items, styles, and accessories. Students may also briefly discuss what they usually wear when they want to feel comfortable or relaxed, connecting clothing choices to wellbeing. The section also develops students' ability to express **temporal references** and **connect ideas logically** using connectors.

Grammar 14:

Grammar topics include **temporal expressions** such as *há* and *desde*, the **indirect object pronouns**, and the use of **connectors** like *quando*, *porque*, *mas*, and *e* to build more coherent and complex sentences.

Exercises 14:

- Describing outfits for different seasons or events
- Filling in the blanks with correct pronouns and time expressions
- Sentence combination using connectors
- Listening comprehension: matching clothing to situations

Writing short descriptions of what people are wearing and why, including context such as weather, comfort, or physical activity (e.g., clothes for sports or relaxing at home).

Class 14 - April 23

Midterm Written Test

This session is dedicated to the Midterm Written Test. The assessment is designed to evaluate students' progress and consolidation of the material covered in the first part of the course, including vocabulary, grammar, reading comprehension, and writing skills. The test will be conducted in class and will have a duration of **1 hour and 30 minutes**, following the format and guidelines previously discussed.

Class 15 - April 28

Language and Communication 15

In this session, students will explore Portuguese **festivals and celebrations**, gaining insight into cultural traditions, holidays, and how they are celebrated in Portugal. Through vocabulary and thematic discussions, students will learn to describe festivities, explain their significance, and express personal preferences and experiences related to celebrations.

Grammar 15:

This unit also revisits and expands the use of **indefinite pronouns**, helping students refer to unspecific people or things in various contexts.

Exercises 15:

- Reading comprehension
- Vocabulary matching
- Group discussion about favorite holidays
- Sentence building using indefinite pronouns
- Listening comprehension

Class 16 - April 30

Language and Communication 16

Students will explore themes related to **physical exercise and healthy lifestyle habits**, learning how to express routines and preferences connected to health and wellness. This section also focuses on **practical communication in healthcare settings**, such as **scheduling a medical appointment** or **buying medication at a pharmacy**.

Grammar 16:

In grammar, students will study the **formal imperative**, which is used to give instructions or advice in formal contexts (e.g., speaking to healthcare professionals, strangers, or in written instructions).

Exercises 16:

- Listening and identifying formal vs. informal commands
- Dialogue completion: marking a doctor's appointment
- Role-play: conversation at the pharmacy
- Matching exercises: health problems and solutions

Writing short dialogues using the formal imperative

Due date: Video Presentation 1 (online)

Class 17 - May 5

Language and Communication 17

Students will explore themes related to parties, festivities, and cultural traditions, focusing on how to describe celebrations and social events in Portuguese. This section also introduces everyday written communication, such as invitations and short digital messages (e.g., SMS), allowing students to practice informal interaction in common social contexts.

Grammar 17

In grammar, students will study **indefinite pronouns**, which are used to refer to non-specific people or things, as well as the use of **tão** and **tanto**, focusing on expressions of quantity and intensity in different communicative situations.

Exercises 17

- Listening to a text and answering comprehension questions
- Identifying true or false statements
- Fill-in-the-blanks exercises
- Writing sentences using target structures
- Matching exercises
- Completing short messages and invitations
- Listening and repeating key vocabulary items

Class 18 - May 7

Language and Communication 18

Students will explore aspects of everyday Portuguese culture, focusing on common social conventions, behavioral norms, and culturally embedded habits. The session encourages learners to observe and describe typical practices, promoting intercultural awareness while expanding vocabulary related to daily interactions and social behavior.

Grammar 18

In grammar, students will revise the **imperative mood**, reinforcing its use in giving instructions, advice, and suggestions. The session also introduces work with **synonyms and opposites**, helping students develop lexical flexibility and precision in expression.

Exercises 18

- Text reading and comprehension

- Listening and comprehension activities
- Answering comprehension and interpretation questions
- Short guided text writing
- Fill-in-the-blanks exercises
- Vocabulary exercises with synonyms and opposites

Class 19 - May 12

Language and Communication 19

Students will develop their ability to refer to past events, focusing on asking for and providing information about previous experiences, holidays, and travel. The session emphasizes communicative strategies for describing personal experiences and discussing situations that occurred in the past, reinforcing narrative skills in everyday contexts.

Grammar 19

In grammar, students will study the **past tense of regular verbs**, consolidating their ability to describe completed actions. The session also focuses on the adverbs **já**, **ainda**, and **nunca**, highlighting their role in expressing temporal relations and experience in past contexts.

Exercises 19

- Text reading and comprehension
- Describing pictures and past situations
- Identifying true or false statements
- Completing sentences using target verb forms
- Guided oral practice with past tense structures

Due date: Video Presentation 2 (online)

Class 20 - May 14

Language and Communication 20

In this session, students will deliver their individual oral presentation in person, expanding on the topic previously developed in **Video Presentation 2**. This activity is designed to reinforce oral proficiency, with particular attention to clarity of expression, pronunciation, and fluency. The presentation must be delivered **without reading from written notes or scripts**. The objective is to assess the student's ability to

communicate ideas **spontaneously and coherently** in Portuguese, drawing on the vocabulary and grammatical structures covered throughout the course. Students are encouraged to use **multimedia support** (images, slides, photos, short videos, objects, etc.). Such materials should function strictly as **visual aids**, not as written prompts for reading.

Duration: 5–7 minutes per student

Following the presentations, general feedback and brief class discussion will take place.

Class 21 - May 19

Language and Communication 21

Students will explore themes related to traveling and moving to another country, with particular attention to personal adaptation, challenges, and wellbeing. The session will encourage learners to discuss experiences of change, including common emotional and psychological aspects of relocation, such as stress, uncertainty, and adjustment to new environments.

Students will also develop vocabulary and communicative strategies to describe **personal challenges**, explain how they cope with difficulties, and exchange **simple advice or suggestions** related to maintaining balance and wellbeing (e.g., habits, routines, social interaction, and self-care).

Grammar 21

In grammar, students will study the **past tense of irregular verbs**, reinforcing their ability to describe past actions and experiences. The session will also review **adverbs of time**, highlighting their function in structuring narratives and expressing temporal relations.

Exercises 21

- Text reading and comprehension
- Describing images and situations
- Comparing past experiences and contexts
- Guided oral practice using irregular verb forms
- Short discussions: personal challenges and coping strategies
- Vocabulary reinforcement activities

Class 22 - May 21

Language and Communication 22

This session is dedicated to a **general course review and oral practice** in preparation for the Final Oral Exam. Students will revisit key communicative situations and essential vocabulary covered throughout the course, with emphasis on everyday interactions. The session will also provide opportunities for learners to reflect on their progress, discuss learning experiences, and reinforce confidence in using Portuguese in simple contexts.

Grammar 22

Students will review core grammatical structures studied during the course, focusing on accuracy and appropriate use in basic communicative tasks. Attention will be given to verb forms, question structures, and frequently used expressions.

Exercises 22

- Guided oral practice in pairs and small groups
- Revision of common communicative situations (e.g., asking for information, describing routines, expressing preferences)
- Short role-play activities based on familiar contexts
- Vocabulary reinforcement exercises
- Open Q&A and clarification of doubts

Class 23 - May 26

Final oral comprehension/speaking test

Class 24 - May 28

Language and Communication 24

This session is dedicated to **revision and clarification** of the main topics covered throughout the course. Students will consolidate essential vocabulary, communicative functions, and language structures required for the final assessments. Special attention will be given to resolving doubts, reinforcing accuracy, and improving confidence in using Portuguese in familiar communicative contexts.

Grammar 24:

The grammar review will focus on reinforcing previously studied structures, with particular emphasis on areas that typically present difficulties. This includes verb forms, pronoun usage, prepositions, and basic sentence organization.

Exercises 24:

- Review quiz and guided revision activities
- Pair and group communication practice
- Grammar correction and reformulation exercises
- Listening and reading comprehension tasks
- Practice activities modeled on exam tasks

Class 25 - June 2

Final exam

Online Resources

Moodle

Course Materials

Recommended Readings

Tavares, A., Rente, S. (2023). *Português a Valer – QECR Nível A1*, Lidel.
(textbook)

Coimbra, O. (2013). *Gramática Ativa 1*, Lidel.

Lemos, H. (2001). *Praticar Português, Nível Elementar*, Lidel.

Malcata, H.(2011). *Guia Prático de Fonética Acentuação e Pontuação*, Lidel.

Matos, M^a Libéria (2007). *Dicionário Ilustrado Português Língua Não Materna*, Porto Editora

Oliveira, C., Coelho L. (2013). *Gramática Aplicada, Níveis Inicial e Elementar A1, A2 e B1*, Texto Editores.